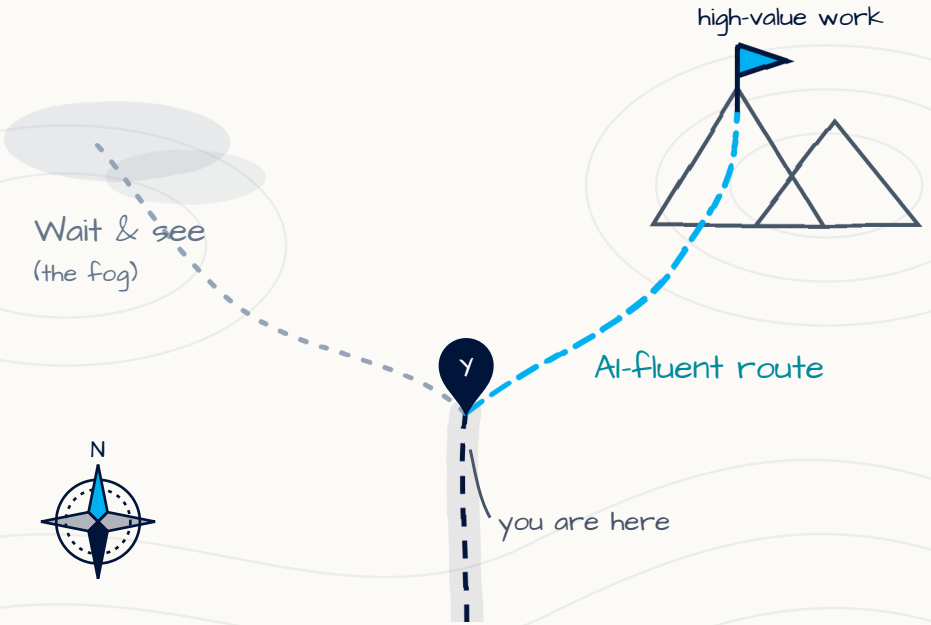
A field map for your career

The AI elite divide

Leaders are quietly splitting teams into two roads. **Here's how to read the map and pick the right path.**



Swipe for the data, the fork and 5 landmark skills →

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What it is & why it matters

What is the "AI elite"?

ai elite (n.)

A small group of employees that leaders see as **AI-fluent**. They tend to get the new projects, the budget and the visibility.

Map legend

why it matters

The new route: work is being redesigned around people who use AI well.

The fog: people who wait get fewer chances to show what they can do.

Good news: this is a skill gap, not a talent gap. You can close it.

On this map:

1 the data

2 the fork

3 5 landmarks

4 30-day route

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The data, part 1

Leaders are already sorting

92% of the C-suite say they are **cultivating an "AI elite"** class of employees.



The divide isn't coming. **It's being drawn now**, in who gets which projects.

A WRITER survey found this (2026; 1,200 executives + 1,200 employees; vendor survey). Each pin = 1%.

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⚠ The data, part 2

A warning sign, not a dead end



The number

60% of executives plan to lay off employees who can't adopt AI.

The real message

The risk sits with people who *won't adopt*, not with any job title.

Your move

Adoption is learnable. The 5 landmark skills ahead show you how.

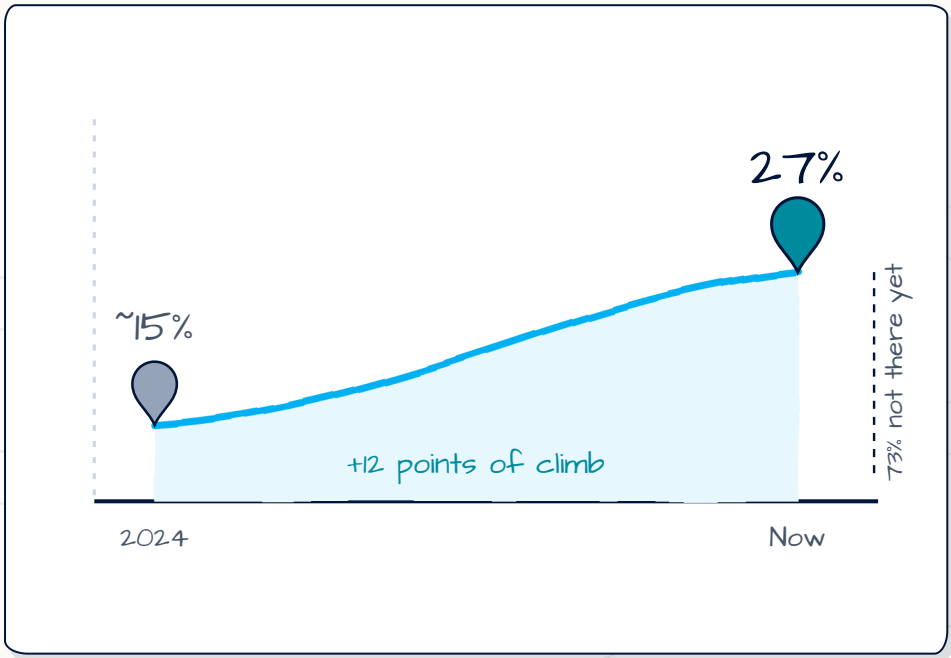
A WRITER survey found this (2026; 1,200 executives + 1,200 employees; vendor survey).

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The data, part 3

The road is still wide open

Frequent AI use is climbing, but **most white-collar workers aren't frequent users yet.** There's room to get ahead.

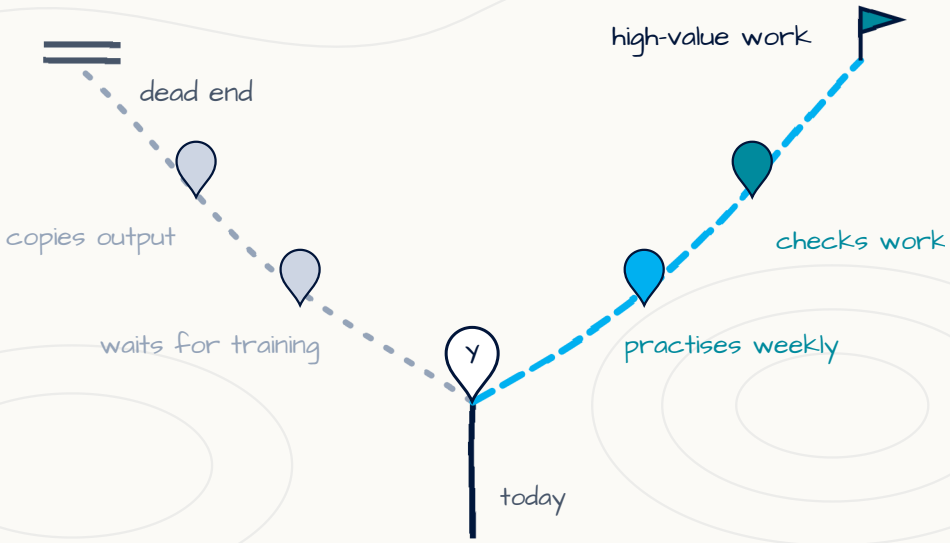


Source: Gallup. 27% of white-collar employees use AI frequently, up 12 points since 2024 (~15% is 27 minus 12).

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The fork

Two routes, same starting point



✗ Wait & see

Uses AI now and then, quietly. Copies first answers. Waits to be trained.

✓ Navigator

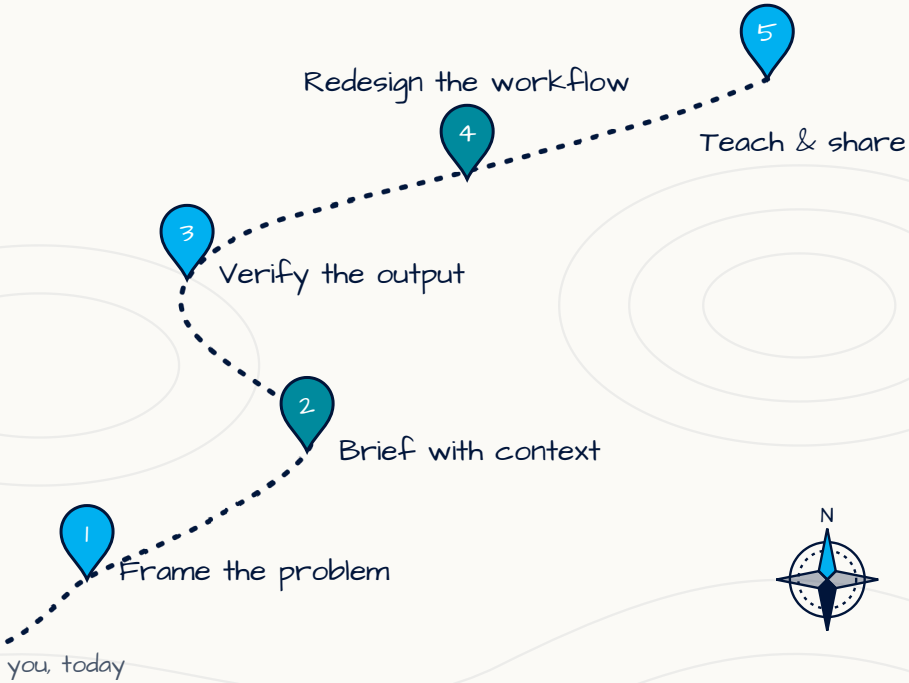
Practises on real work, checks output, redesigns tasks, shares what works.

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The route

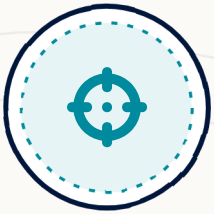
5 landmarks on the right road

The people leaders call "AI elite" aren't wizards. They've passed **5 landmark skills**, in roughly this order.



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Landmark 1



landmark 1

Frame the problem

Know what "good" looks like before you open AI.

Looks like

"I need a one-page summary my director can decide from in 2 minutes."

Practise this week

Before each AI task, write one line: the goal, the reader, the finish line.

You've arrived when

Your first prompt is rarely your last, but your goal never changes.

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Landmark 2



landmark 2

Brief with context

Give AI what a new colleague would need.

Looks like

Audience, background, tone, a sample of past work, and the format you want.

Practise this week

Ask AI: "What else do you need to know?" Answer, then let it write.

You've arrived when

First drafts need small edits, not total rewrites.

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Landmark 3



landmark 3

Verify the output

Treat every answer as a draft until you've checked it.

Looks like

Checking each number, name, quote and claim against the source.

Practise this week

Ask AI: "Which parts of this are you least sure about?" Check those first.

You've arrived when

Nothing leaves your desk that you couldn't defend line by line.

Landmark 4



landmark 4

Redesign the workflow

Don't bolt AI onto old steps. Rethink the job.

Looks like

A weekly report goes from 5 manual steps to 3, with AI on 2 of them.

Practise this week

Map one recurring task on paper. Circle the steps AI could draft or check.

You've arrived when

You can show minutes saved per week, with quality kept.

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Landmark 5



landmark 5

Teach & share

The fastest way up is to bring people with you.

Looks like

A shared prompt doc, a 10-minute demo at team meeting, a buddy you help.

Practise this week

Show one colleague one workflow that saves you time.

You've arrived when

People come to you to ask how. That is what leaders notice.

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Wrong turns

4 dead ends to avoid

These feel like progress. They don't get you to the summit.

~~Collecting tools~~

Detour →
Get good at **one** assistant first.

~~Prompt "hacks"~~

Detour →
Clear goals and context beat tricks.

~~Hiding your AI use~~

Detour →
Say how you used it and how you checked it.

~~Waiting for permission~~

Detour →
Start with safe, low-risk tasks today. Follow company rules.

Rule of thumb: if it doesn't change **how you do a real task**, it's scenery, not progress.

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Your 30-day route

Your 30-day route

One landmark a week. About 20 minutes a day, on real work.

1

Day 1

Pick 2 tasks you repeat every week.

2

Day 7

Frame + brief: goal line and context for each.

3

Day 14

Check everything. Log what AI got wrong.

4

Day 21

Redesign one task end-to-end. Time it.

5

Day 30

Show one colleague. Share your numbers.

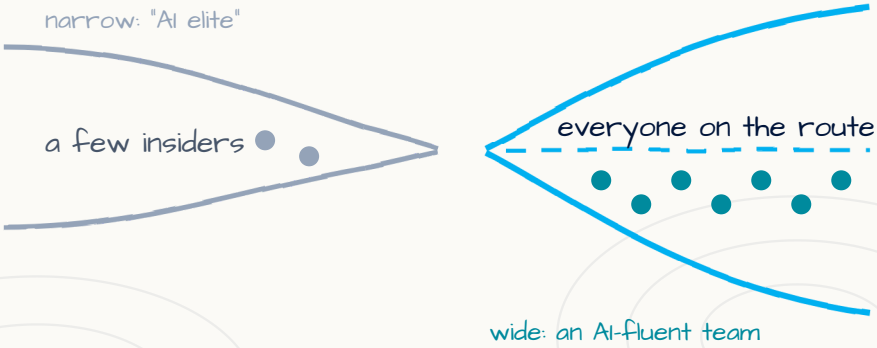

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For leaders

Don't build a club. Widen the road.



- **Open training** to every role, not a chosen few.
- **Share playbooks** from early adopters.
- **Reward sharing**, not secret shortcuts.
- **Measure outcomes**, not logins.

An "elite" that keeps its skills to itself becomes a bottleneck. **A team that shares them moves faster.**

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Map legend: save this

The 5 landmarks

1. **Frame the problem**
   Write the goal, reader and finish line first.

2. **Brief with context**
   Give the context a new colleague would need.

3. **Verify the output**
   Every answer is a draft until checked.

4. **Redesign the workflow**
   Rethink the task, then add AI to 2 steps.

5. **Teach & share**
   Show one colleague. Share your numbers.

Follow AI Coach John · DM "PROITBRIDGE" to discuss your AI project

Save this map · Repost it for someone at the fork

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